RUST SERVER PLUGIN
DEPT. OF ISLAND INFRASTRUCTURE
V2.11.3

PUBLICWORKS

YOUR SCRAP AT WORK

A plugin that opens a **Public Works office** on the island. One clerk, nine municipal utilities, one shared bucket per service. Anyone can walk in and pay **100 scrap** to bank a day of service — power, water, gas, cold groceries, free trains, **Cobalt air cover — for everyone on the server**. The more people using it, **the faster the meter runs**. Things break: transformers blow, mains burst, pumps seize — **and somebody has to go fix them**. The shops are open: fuel pumps and a corner store at every gas station, groceries and drone delivery at the supermarket — and yes, the vodka is drinkable. Civilization, by the day, cash only.

PUBLIC SERVICE ANNOUNCEMENTS

ACTUAL GAME CHAT

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Public Works: Water service is now ACTIVE — Water Treatment stays pressurized (paid for by a passing stranger). Usage scales with population.
Public Works: a transformer blew at the power grid (grid J14, red dot on the map) — Electricity is running at half capacity. Repair crew ETA ~45m. Repair contract at the office: 75 scrap.
Public Works: drained 14 low grade fuel from the pump.
Public Works: gulp — the Vodka Bottle goes down the hatch.
Public Works: that batch was... off. It comes straight back up — and snake venom burns through your veins!
Public Works: a passing stranger called in a resupply at the Airfield — the air traffic controller is on break, next locked crate ready in 10 minutes.
Public Works: Cobalt air defence has flagged you as hostile for 2m (shot the patrol helicopter).
Public Works: Cobalt Accounts has put the Protection account on hold — payment delayed, air cover suspended. Settle the bill at the office: 50 scrap.
Public Works: work order filed for the pole at grid K12: 250 scrap. Pay it at the office, or call 55596757 (+10 scrap) and a crew will come out. /pw pole cancel withdraws it.
Public Works: work order paid (-260 scrap). A crew is on its way to grid K12 — about 32 seconds out.
Public Works: drone delivery is offline until the Supermarket fault is repaired — the grocery inside is still open.
Public Works: Electricity restored — emergency repairs by a passing stranger (+75 scrap).
Public Works: Gas is running low — about 55m left at current usage. Visit the office to extend it!
Public Works: Markets service has EXPIRED.
the supermarket freezer quietly stops humming.
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Every line is real plugin output. The whole island hears when a utility comes online, **who paid for it**, when something breaks, and **who fixed it**. Nothing motivates a scrap run like the lights going out at the gas station.

THE SERVICES

100 SCRAP / DAY EACH · ONE SHARED METER PER SERVICE

ELECTRICITY

The Power Plant and every street powerline stay live — and pole transformers put out **double power** while the bill is paid. Wire your base to the grid.

WATER

Water Treatment stays pressurized. Tanks full, valves open, no gears required.

GAS

All three Dome crude pumps run continuously — no oil rig field trip. Each pump holds **500 crude**, then waits for someone to come collect.

MARKETS

Freezers stay cold, the **grocery store is open**, and **delivery drones** fly from the supermarket roof. The island's only full-service shop.

GARAGES

Gas station lifts and doors stay powered — the **fuel pumps work** and the **corner store is open**. Bring a hose tool, leave with a full tank and snacks.

AIRPORT

The control tower is **staffed and powered, no fuses** — airdrops run at **double rate** and a **Chinook resupply** is one button press away, every ten minutes.

INTERNET

The satellite uplink stays online and item-free. No tech trash, no aiming modules, free thrusters.

TRANSPORTATION

Every train on the island runs without fuel. Board, throttle, go. The subway is now public transit.

PROTECTION

The patrol heli and Bradley go **reactive only** — they ignore everyone who leaves them alone, and Bradley **never drops its ground crew**. Shoot first, and Cobalt remembers.

WORK ORDERS

V2.10 · THE DEPARTMENT MAKES HOUSE CALLS

WORK ORDER

PICK A POLE. FILE THE PAPERWORK.

Only some roadside poles carry a transformer you can wire into. Stand at a plain one, type **/pw pole**, and the department opens a work order for it — **250 scrap**, one per player per wipe. Nothing gets built until the bill is paid.

DISPATCH

A TRUCK ACTUALLY SHOWS UP

Pay, and a **department pickup** appears down the road, drives to your pole, and a worker climbs out. Fifteen seconds later there's a **transformer on the pole** and the truck is gone. It can't be shot, looted or borrowed. Road blocked? The order gets fitted anyway.

PUBLIC HOOKUP

SAME TRANSFORMER, PLUS A LADDER

It's the very transformer the game hangs on its own poles — same ports, same output, live while Electricity is paid. Plain poles can't be climbed, so the crew **leaves two indestructible ladders**. Anyone can wire in: it's public works, not private works. Gone at wipe.

555-WORKS

CALL IT IN

Dial **5559-6757** from any telephone — it's in the directory — and the services panel opens where you stand. Pay for a day of service, a work order or a Cobalt billing hold for a **10 scrap convenience fee**. Repair contracts are still handed out in person.

CIVIC RECORD

V2.9 · COBALT NOTICES WHO FIXES THINGS

COMMENDATION

THE REPAIR GOES ON YOUR FILE

With **Cobalt Papers Please** on the server, finishing a repair contract earns standing with Cobalt: **+10 for a minor fault, +20 for a major one**. Fix enough of the grid and the checkpoint guards start waving you through.

TAXPAYER

FUNDING COUNTS, A LITTLE

Paying the clerk for a day of any service earns **+2, once a day**. It's civic duty, not a loophole. Plugin authors get two hooks, **OnPublicWorksRepair** and **OnPublicWorksPurchase**, to build on.

BUDGET CUTS

V2.7.7 · NON-ESSENTIAL SERVICES

NON-ESSENTIAL

COBALT SAYS NO

Server operators can now **shelve any of the nine services** from the config. A shelved service stays on the office board — grayed out, no gauge, no PAY button — stamped **"Cobalt has deemed this service non-essential"**. The clerk won't take your scrap for it, and the fault scheduler leaves it alone. Head office has spoken.

BUDGET FREEZE

THE METER STOPS. THE MONEY KEEPS.

Time already banked on a shelved service is **frozen, not refunded** — no drain, no expiry, no faults. Reinstate the service and the meter picks up exactly where it left off. (And since v2.7.8, a typo in the config can't wipe your settings — the department **refuses to overwrite a broken file** and runs on defaults until it's fixed.)

AIR TRAFFIC CONTROL

V2.7.5 · THE TOWER IS STAFFED

NO FUSES

THE LIGHTS ARE ON UPSTAIRS

Vanilla wants two fuses in the tower's fuse boxes before either terminal wakes up. While Airport is paid the department **wires the terminals directly** and seats a locked **Public Works Fuse** in each box — no sparks, screens lit, meters full. The **supply dispatcher** stays active (airdrops at **2× rate**, always) and the **resupply terminal** is charged and ready. Pull the fuse? "Item is locked in."

ON BREAK

NEXT LOCKED CRATE IN 10 MINUTES

Press the button and a **Chinook brings a locked crate** to the airfield — then the air traffic controller takes a **10-minute break**, announced island-wide with the minutes left. Vanilla would lock the terminal for **three hours** after one call; the department cuts that to a coffee. Lapse the bill and the tower goes dark, fuses and all, back to vanilla.

AIR COVER

V2.7 · COBALT DEFENCE, BY SUBSCRIPTION

REACTIVE ONLY

THE HELI IGNORES YOU. UNTIL.

Paid up, the patrol helicopter and the Bradley APC **only engage aggressors**. Walk under the heli with a rifle out, drive past the tank at Launch Site — nothing. Hooks-only, no convars, no saved state: the second the bill lapses, **both are pure vanilla again**.

HOSTILE

TWO WAYS TO GET FLAGGED

Put a round into the heli or the Bradley, or **hit another player within 150 m** of either one, and Cobalt flags you hostile for **2 minutes** — refreshed every time you do it again; dying settles it. Both vehicles share the list. Chat tells you exactly why.

YOUR TEAM

CONSEQUENCES FOR EVERYONE

When you get flagged, **your whole team gets flagged**. Your clanmate starts a fight under the heli, the heli starts a fight with you. Hostile players are still subject to the vanilla rules — line of sight, the 40 m night rule — the service only ever **removes** targets, never adds them.

BILLING HOLD

THE FAULT IS AN INVOICE

Protection's fault has no crash site — **Cobalt Accounts puts the account on hold**. Minor: payment delayed, air cover lapses (heli vanilla, Bradley still tame). Major: account frozen, both vanilla. The red dot lands on the office; hit **PAY BILL** there — **50 / 100 scrap**, no payout. Nobody gets paid by Cobalt for paying Cobalt.

OPEN FOR BUSINESS

V2.4–2.5 · THE SHOPS ACTUALLY WORK

FUEL PUMPS

PUMPS THAT PUMP

A row of three working fuel pumps **behind every gas station building** while Garages is paid (the ones out front are scenery — the real pumps are round the back). They fill with **low grade** around the clock (250 cap each) — **hold a hose tool and press E** to drain one into your inventory. First one there gets the tank.

GROCERIES

THE STORE IS OPEN

A **Public Works Grocery** inside every supermarket while Markets is paid — eggs, bread, apples, honey — and a **corner store** at every gas station while Garages is: chocolate, granola, canned goods. Each shop stocks its own shelf, restocked by the department. Scrap spent here leaves the economy — a bill you can eat.

DRONE DELIVERY

AIR MAIL, BUT GROCERIES

A real **drone marketplace** operates from the supermarket roof — order from any vending machine on the island and a department drone flies it in. Same machinery as the fishing villages, now municipal.

BOTTOM SHELF

THE VODKA IS REAL `/drink`

The **Mr Spice Can** and **Vodka Bottle** junk items are actually drinkable now — type **/drink**, or put one on your belt, holster, and **right-click to swig**. Spice heals and hydrates; vodka heals harder, blurs your vision for 20 seconds, and carries a **15% chance the batch is bad**: you throw it straight back up — no buzz, no heal, pickle-jar roulette — plus real snakebite venom, straight off the snake. Drink responsibly. Or don't.

CLOSING TIME

NO BILL, NO SERVICE

Stop paying and the shops stay standing but **close** — pumps idle, the grocers turn you away, the drone terminals go dark. A minor fault grounds the drones first; a major one shutters the whole store. The office takes scrap.

STOCKED BY CONFIG

THE DEPARTMENT SETS PRICES

Every shop's shelf is a config list — **seven items per machine** (the game's own vending limit), each a shortname, quantity, and scrap price, with separate lists for the supermarket and the gas stations. Ship fresh produce, or run a state liquor store. Purchases restock themselves every five minutes.

FAULT EVENTS

SINCE V2 · MUNICIPAL DECAY, SIMULATED

SOMETHING BREAKS

ABOUT ONCE A DAY, SOMETHING BREAKS

A transformer blows on the grid, a water main bursts, a signal box fails at the Train Yard. Random faults hit active services only: minor faults cut output to **50%** — half pump flow, drones grounded — major faults go **full blackout**. The meter keeps running either way — that's the pressure.

OPEN CONTRACT

TAKE THE JOB. IT'S A RACE.

The office posts one open repair contract per fault. **Anyone can accept it**; first to finish the repair gets paid — **75** scrap minor, **150** major, plus bonus hours banked on the fixed service. Everyone else gets exercise.

REPAIR RUN

BRING PARTS, PRESS E

A **red dot** marks the fault site. Haul the materials — metal fragments, gears, fuses, pipe — across the island and press **E** at the site. Dying on the way with a backpack full of gears is part of the fee.

THE CREW

THE DEPARTMENT FIXES IT — EVENTUALLY

Ignore a fault and the Public Works crew repairs it themselves in **45–90 minutes**. Nothing stays broken forever. Heroes just get there first — **and get paid**.

HOW IT WORKS

MUNICIPAL BUREAUCRACY, SIMULATED

THE CLERK

ONE NPC, ZERO VIOLENCE

An invincible, disarmed, AI-disabled clerk staffs the office (orange dot on your map). Walk up, press **E**, and the services panel opens — status lights, time remaining, and a PAY button per service. Away from the office, **/pwinfo** shows every meter, read-only. Paying your bill takes the trip — or a **phone call**.

THE BUCKET ECONOMY

ONE BUCKET, DRAINED BY DEMAND

Every service is a **shared bucket of banked time** — strangers' payments pour into the same bucket, capped at **7 days**. Two players sip at 1×; every extra player online opens the tap wider (+25%, capped at 3×). The panel shows **fuel-gauge bars** and time left at current usage, so everyone knows when to pass the hat. Bots don't count. Payers get named.

REAL MACHINERY

BUILT ON THE ACTUAL POWER GRID

Services drive the real **Power Trip** monument machinery — the same generators, pumps, and freezers players power with heavy fuses. The fuel pumps are the Dome's own crude machinery, retargeted. Vanilla fuse gameplay keeps working alongside; when a service lapses, everything **reverts to vanilla** on its own.

NO LOOPHOLES

THE FUEL HATCH IS SEALED

Free trains could have been an infinite low-grade faucet. Instead, fuel hatches are **sealed while Transportation is active**, tanks refill the instant anyone boards, and surplus fuel is drained back when the service expires. The gas station pumps cap at 250 fuel and the Dome at 500 crude — nothing accumulates forever.

UTILITY NOTICES

WARNINGS BEFORE THE LIGHTS GO OUT

Chat announcements fire when a service activates, **60 and 10 minutes before it lapses**, and when it finally expires. The panel shows banked time against the cap — **4d 12h / 7d** — so everyone knows exactly when to pass the hat.

THE OFFICE

A REAL OFFICE, WITH A SOUNDTRACK

The department lives in a real monument office (currently Radtown), **anchored so it re-opens in the same room after every map wipe** — as do the pumps, the grocery, and the drone pad. The clerk wears a proper uniform, turns to greet you, and an **indestructible boombox** plays office radio around the clock — staff retune it through the radio dial, civilians get told it's department property. Every message is **translatable** via the Lang API. CopyPaste support included for custom-built branch offices.

BY THE NUMBERS

9 UTILITIES	**100** SCRAP = 24H BANKED	**×3** PEAK USAGE RATE	**7d** MAX IN THE BUCKET
250 FUEL CAP PER PUMP	**15%** BAD VODKA ODDS	**150** TOP REPAIR PAYOUT	**2m** HOSTILE FLAG, SHARED

PUBLICWORKS · AN OXIDE PLUGIN BY LOWPOPLABS · MIT

YOUR SCRAP AT WORK

PAY YOUR BILL. FIX A FAULT. EVERYONE RIDES.